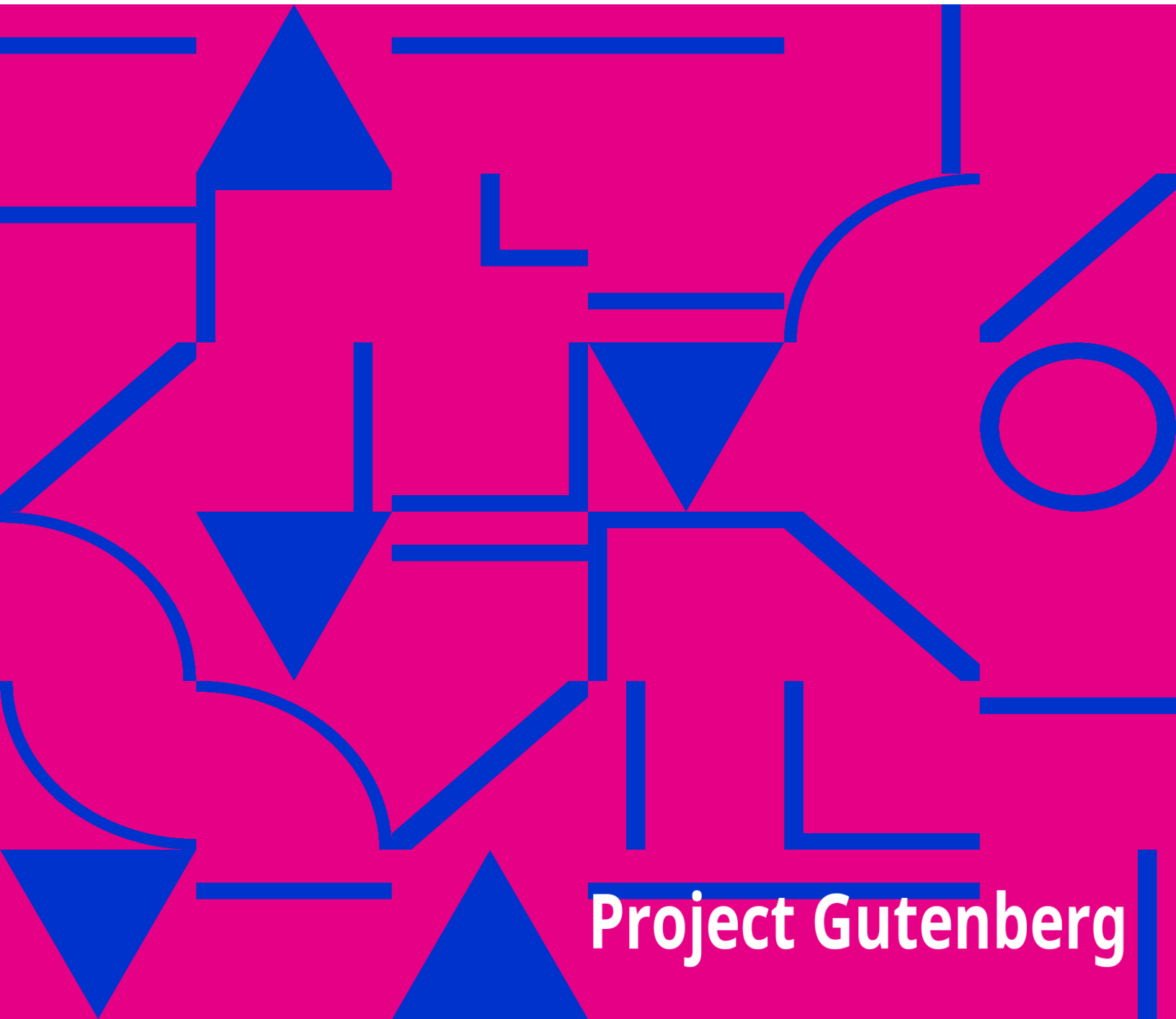


Daddy Do-Funny's Wisdom Jingles

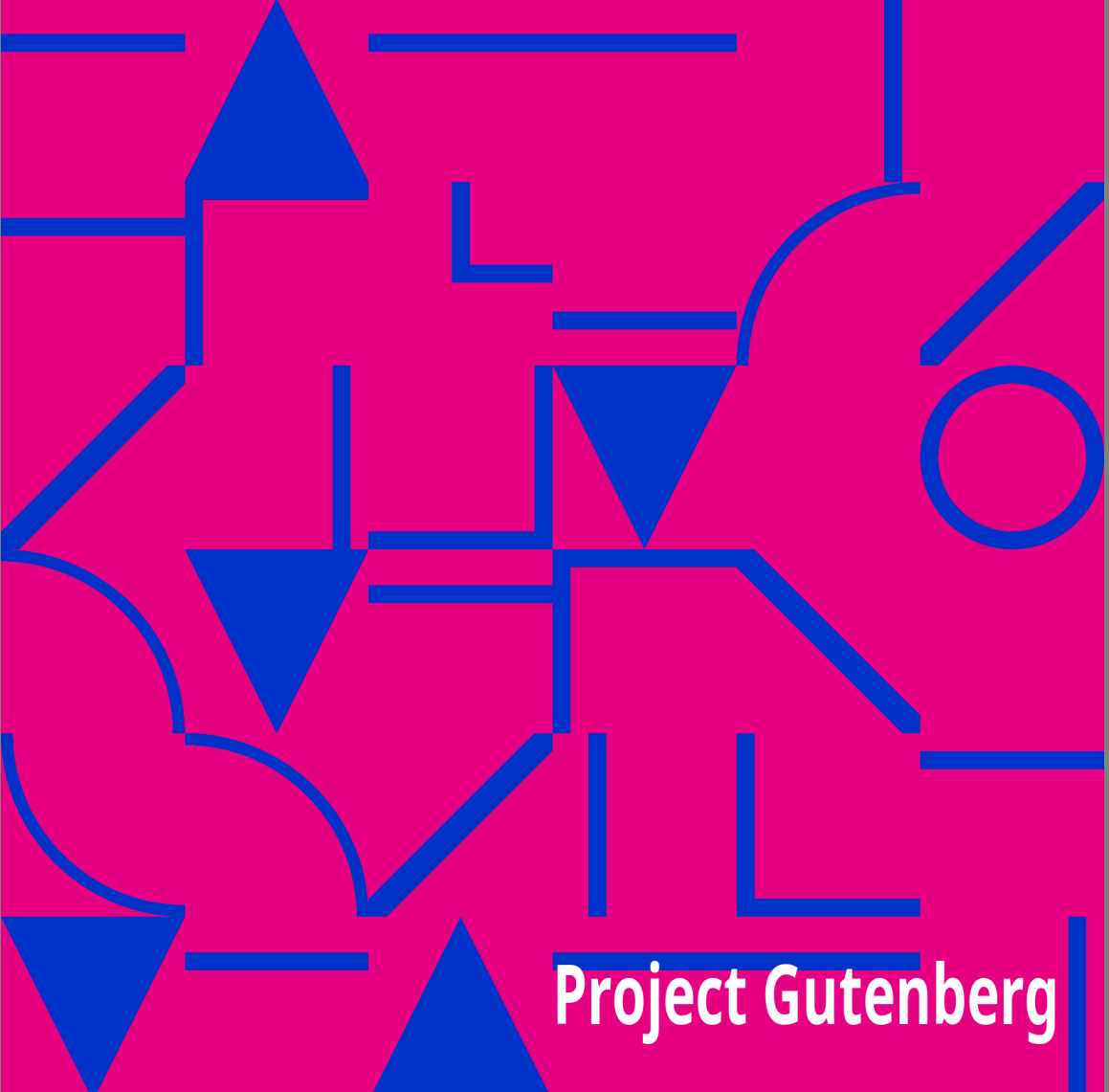
Ruth McEnergy Stuart



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Daddy Do-Funny's Wisdom Jingles

Ruth McEnergy Stuart

An abstract geometric pattern on a magenta background. It features various blue shapes including triangles, squares, circles, and lines, some of which are nested or overlapping. The pattern is dense and covers the lower two-thirds of the page.

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*** START OF THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK DADDY DO-FUNNY'S WISDOM JINGLES ***

DADDY DO-FUNNY'S

WISDOM JINGLES

BY

RUTH McENERY STUART

ILLUSTRATED BY G. H. CLEMENTS

NEW YORK
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1916

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DADDY'S WEATHER PRAYER
THE OLD ROOSTER
THE BUTTERFLY
THE WREN
THE WATERMELON
THE GOURD
JUDGE OWL
THE MOSQUITO
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TRIED BY FIRE
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WILL O' THE WISP
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THE RUNT
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THE FIG
THE FRIZZLED CHICKEN
THE ENDLESS SONG
THE EEL
THE RAIN-CROW
THE GIRAFFE
THE BLACK SHEEP
THE PRIZE-WINNER
THE DOG

To the Memory of those faithful brown slave-men of the plantations throughout the South, Daddy's contemporaries all, who during the war while their masters were away fighting in a cause opposed to their emancipation, brought their blankets and slept outside their mistresses' doors, thus keeping night-watch over otherwise unprotected women and children—a faithful guardianship of which the annals of those troublous times record no instance of betrayal.

FOREWORD

In presenting a loyal and venerable ex-slave as an artless exponent of freedom, freedom of conduct as well as of speech, the author of this trivial volume is perhaps not composing an individual so truly as individualizing a composite, if the expression will pass.

The grizzled brown dispenser of homely admonitions is a figure not unfamiliar to those who have "moved in plantation circles" in the cotton and sugar country, and touched hands with the kindly dark survivors of the old regime.

If the man, Daddy Do-funny, was unique as an individual, perhaps in the very fact of an individuality unembarrassed by the limitations of convention, of education and of precedent, he becomes in a sense typical of his people and of his time.

Of course, a man is not called Do-funny for nothing, not even playfully and in the free vernacular of rusticity at its freest.

One of a small community of superannuated pensioners upon the bounty of their former owners, Daddy was easily first citizen of Evergreen annex on Crepe Myrtle plantation, which is to say he was therein a personage of place and of privilege, coming and going at will, doing as he pleased, and as, with uplifted eye, he reverently boasted, "sponsible to nobody but Almighty Gord for manners and behavior."

Even so late as this year of grace, a full half century after "emancipation," there are still to be found on many of the larger plantations in the far South a few such members of the order of the Rocking-chair, whose records of "good and honorable service" reach back through periods of bondage, even such kindergartners as septuagenarians in the privileged class, having clear title to nearly a quarter of a century of slave memories; not to mention the occasional centenarian with even his semi-occasional uncle or father poking around, toothless and white-plumed dignitaries, these, sometimes with leaders, being blind, but ever important in pride of association and memory.

It is something even if one is bent double and may never again behold the light of day, to be able to reach back into a dim and forgotten past and to say, "I remember," especially when the memory recalls days of brilliance and of importance.

But Daddy's place among the gentle Knights and Ladies of the Rocking-chair was far and away above such as these whose thoughts, alert though they were and loyal, travelled forever backward to the sweet but worn fields of memory where every pleasure is a recognition and fashions do not change—a restful retreat for dreamers whose days of activity are done.

But Daddy's mind worked forward and upward and although he did not know the alphabet excepting by rote, a common ante-bellum plantation accomplishment, and while professing high contempt for what he called "cold shelf-knowledge," his reputation for wisdom, wisdom as gleaned in observation and experience and "ripened by insight," was supreme, while his way of casually tossing it off in bits in playful epigram finally gave the word its plural form so that the expression "Do-Funny Wisdoms" came into familiar use.

As an example of his rambling talk, much of which seems at least semivagarious on transcription, I recall one of his meandering dissertations on the value of experience as superior to observation.

Several of the old people, his neighbors, had joined the listening children who surrounded him under the fig-tree, and perhaps he unconsciously deferred to them in his accent of their common possession in length of days, although he gave no sign of heed to any audience, when he said:

"Dey's mighty few facts de same behind an' befo', not to say inside an' outside, and a man can go roun' an' roun' de blackberry bush an' not git nowhar. 'Spe'unce is a thorny bramble, an' yer 'bleeged to go *th'ough* it, to *draw blood*, an', I tell yer, *de blood is de life!*"

Although this tribute brought grunts of approval from the gray heads, Daddy was soon off at a tangent in playful fancy, hitting off a foible or "celebrating truth and justice" in one of the unconscious epigrams which it is sought herein to preserve, even when having occasionally to hammer them into shape, for, while Daddy was almost unerring in rhyme, his

rhythm, never at fault in delivery, was strictly a temperamental matter, not adequately renderable in cold print.

But more than as philosopher, satirist or seer was the old man distinguished as a social factor on the place. Wherever his chair was set, there were the children gathered together, both black and white, eager listeners to his quaint pictorial recitals, even seeming to cherish the "Wisdoms" which fell from his tongue, as is not a common way with children, who seem instinctively to spurn the obviously didactic.

But Daddy's moralizing, besides its saving grace of imagery, was generally sequential and convincing; while his repartee, to use a word which seems almost a misfit in this rural setting, had a way of hitting the mark and striking fire, as when, in reply to the question from a forth-putting youngster on one occasion, "Where do you keep all your wisdoms, Daddy?" he snapped:

"In my ole toof holes, dat's whar! Wisdoms don't ripen good tel yo' toofs is ready to drap out. Ev'rybody knows dat Gord A'mighty ain't nuver is set but one live Wisdom-toof in a man's mouf—an' dat comes late an' goes early."

And then he added with a mischievous smile:

"You-all smarty undergrowth, you ain't chawed life yit. You jes 'speramintin' wid yo' milk-toofs.

"Now's yo' havin' time, chillen, but *to have an' to lose, dat's life!*

"Study wisdom now an' minch on it good wid yo yo'ng baby toofs an' hol' fas' to it, so's it'll meller down ripe, time de caverns opens for it.

"But look out! I knows a lot o' ole vacant wisdom caves for rent behin' dis crepe myrtle hedge—so, I say, watch and pray! Pray for insight an' oversight! An' even so, dey's some wisdoms so fine you can't see 'em tel you nearin' Home an' livin' on de far side o' life!"

Daddy lived alone in a tiny vine-clad cabin and there were times when he seemed frail and to need care, and the doctor said he was rheumatic. This, however, he denied, declining companionship while he insisted that the sharp pains which occasionally twisted his brow were only growing pains

which he was glad to endure as not having got his growth in his first childhood, he was "'bleeged to wrastle wid it in de second," and, "of course," he added, "it comes harder when a man's bones is set."

On days when his pains were bad, he would propel himself around in a roller-chair, which he called his chariot; and although evidently suffering, he was never heard to complain. Once, when he seemed almost helpless, some one asked him how he had got into the chair, and was quickly silenced by his ready answer, "Gord lifted me in!"

Now, to Daddy clothes were clothes. In dress as in manners, he knew no obligation of precedent; and as to fashion, the word made him chuckle.

When his pains were unusually severe and it was difficult for him to get into his own garments, he did not hesitate to clothe himself in one of the flowing wrappers which his old wife, Judy, long since dead, had worn.

And thus it happened that while on some days an aged man might have been seen hobbling about, working among his plants, on others there appeared to be an old woman propelling herself around in a rolling chair; and seeing her, his neighbors, with perhaps a chuckle, would remark, "I see Daddy Do-funny is laid up ag'in!"

Another peculiar habit of the old man was the way in which he took his bath—a dangerous process, one would think, for a rheumatic, but harmless, no doubt, to growing pains. Seeing the rain coming, he would exclaim: "Gord sendeth de rain! He's offerin' me a bath—just or unjust!" Then donning his "bath-slip," an old wool wrapper of Judy's and getting into his roller-chair, he would wheel out and sit calmly in the shower, often closing his eyes and lifting his face as he exclaimed: "Bless Gord for de sweet drops! Bless Gord for de rain!" and when he had had bath enough, he would either put up his umbrella or roll his chair indoors as he felt inclined.

But perhaps we cannot get nearer the soul of the old man than by recalling a conversation which occurred during an invasion of the children, a conversation between him and his guests which is thrown into a sort of rhyme for easy memorizing, passing from one speaker to another without more than the natural pause for reply.

Obviously, the children began it:

"Ol' Daddy Do-funny,
How do you come on?"
"Po'ly, thank Gord, honey,
Po'ly dis morn.
My ol' spine it's sort o' stiff,
An' my arms dey 'fuze to lif'.
An' de miz'ry 's in my breas',
An' I got some heart-distress.
An' de growin' pains dey lingers,
In my knee-j'int's an' my fingers,
But I'm well, praise Gord, dis mornin'."

"Ol' Daddy Do-funny,
What cuyus talk!
How is you well, when you
Can't even walk?"

"Hush, you foolish chillen, hush!
What's dat singin' in de brush?
Ain't dat yonder blue de sky?
Feel de cool breeze passin' by!
Dis ol' painful back an' knee,
Laws-a-mussy, **dey ain't me!**
I'm well, praise Gord, dis mornin'!"

RUTH McENERY STUART.

DADDY DO-FUNNY'S WISDOM JINGLES



DADDY'S WEATHER PRAYER

One asks for sun, an' one for rain,
An' sometimes bofe together;
I prays for sunshine in my heart,
An' den forgits de weather



THE OLD ROOSTER

crowd;

Ef de hoa'se ol' rooster wouldn't crow so loud
He mought pass for yo'ng in de barn-yard

But he strives so hard an' he steps so spry
Dat de pullets all winks whilst he marches by.
An' he ain't by 'isself in dat, in dat--
An' he ain't by 'isself in dat.

THE BUTTERFLY

Sis' Butterfly aimed to work all right,
But 'er wings dey was heavy, an' 'er head too
light;
So she riz in de air, 'ca'ze she see she was
made
Jes' to fly in de sun in de beauty parade.
An' she ain't by 'erself in dat, in dat--
An' she ain't by 'erself in dat.

THE WREN

She's a citizen-bird, Sis little
brown Wren,
She nests in de spring an' de fall
again;
"Race suicide" talk nuver fazes
her,
'Ca'ze she's good for 'er ten little
wrens a year.
An' she ain't by 'erself, my
ladies, in dat—
No, she ain't by 'erself in dat.



THE WATERMELON



Oh, Watermilion sho' is good to
eat!

But de darkie rates it twice-t mo'
sweet,

'Ca'ze it's ap' to b'long to de yether
man,

An' it's mighty hard to lif' by
sleight o' han'.

An' it ain't by itself, made
sweet like dat—

No, it ain't by itself like dat.

THE GOURD



De green gou'd on de sunny shed
Was mighty proud of his pethy
head,
So he nuver pondered or studied or
trained,
An' now he's ol' an' rattle-brained.
An' he ain't by 'isself in dat, in
dat--
An' he ain't by 'isself in dat.

JUDGE OWL

Jedge Owl 's so pompious on 'is limb,
You'd s'pose dey was nobody roun' but him;
He's afeard ef he was too polite
You'd ax 'im whar he spent de night.
 An' he ain't by 'isself in dat, in dat--
 An' he ain't by 'isself in dat.

THE MOSQUITO



Wid so much Christian blood in 'is
veins,

You'd think Br'er 'Skitty would
take some pains

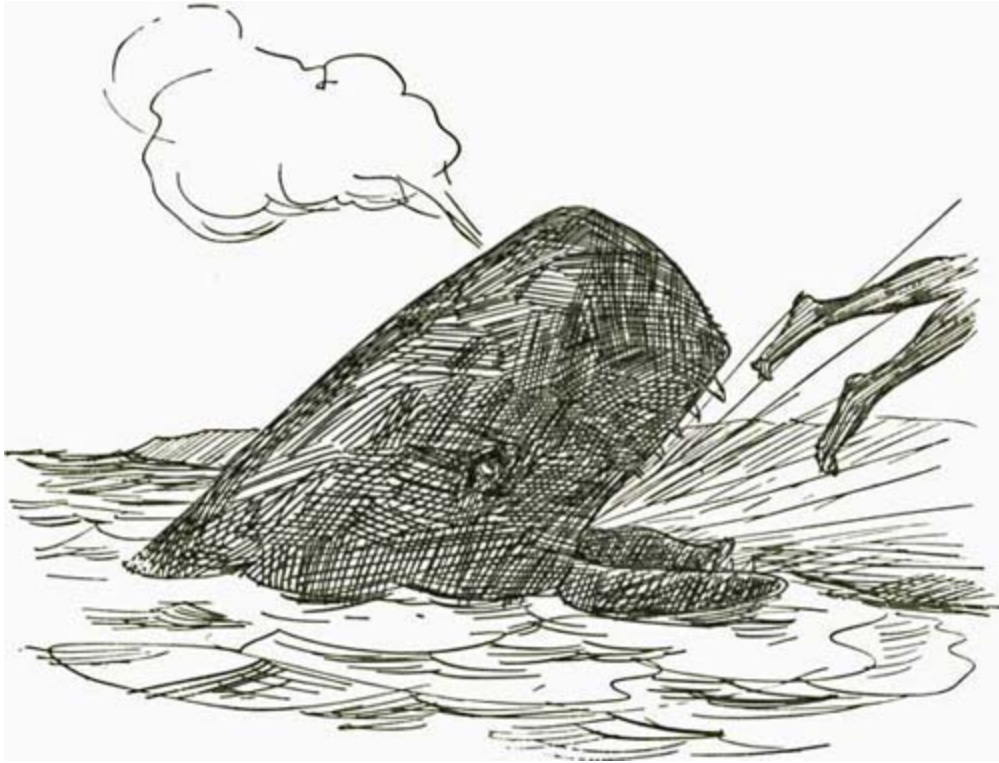
To love 'is neighbor an' show good
will,

But he's p'izenin' an' back-bitin'
still.

An' he ain't by 'isself in dat, in
dat—

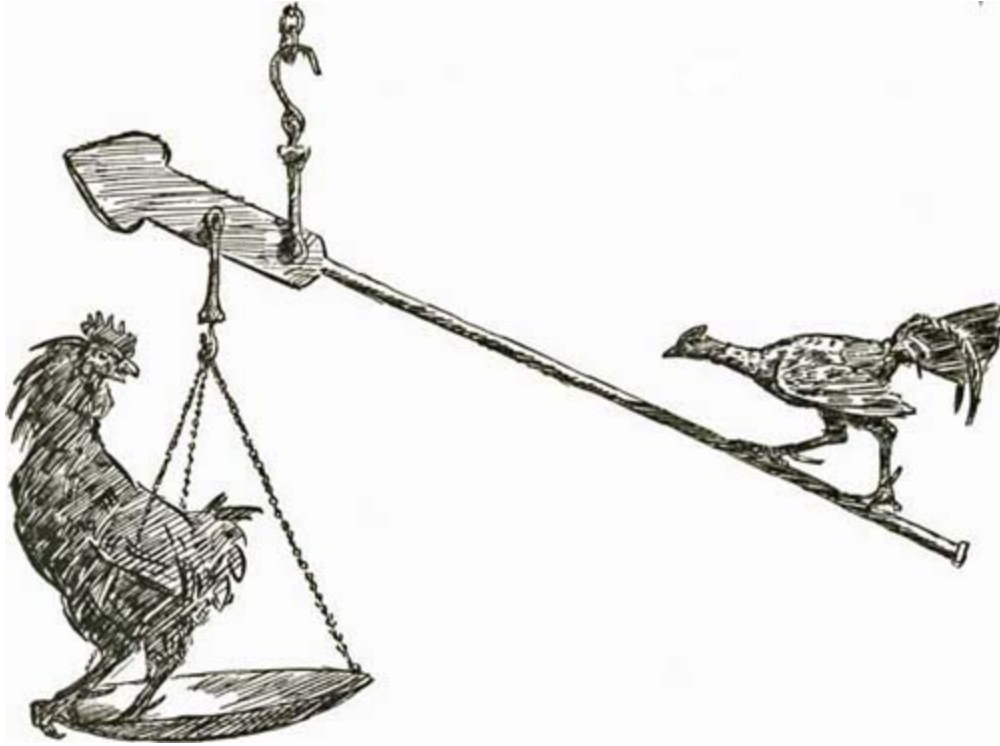
No, he ain't by 'isself in dat.

CONFESSION



Dat whale wha' gulped Br'er Jonah
down
Was bleege'd to swim close-t to de
groun'
Ontel he riz up an' confessed
He'd swallered mo' 'n he could
digest.
But you ain't by yo'self, Br'er
Whale, in dat—
No, you ain't by yo'self in dat.

THE GAME-COCK



Dey's some things square an' some
things round,
An' little game cocks ain't sol' by
de pound;
Dey's weighed by sand an' pluck
an' grit
An' de number o' dead dey leave in
de pit.
An' dey ain't by deyselves in
rank like dat—
No, dey ain't by deyselves in
dat.

THE EPICURE



Ef you keep yo' eyes on Br'er
Carrion Crow,
You'll wonder huccome he kin
carry on so!
He flies in high circles an' chooses
meat
Dat no honest workin'-man would
eat.
An' he ain't no new high-flyer
in dat—
No, he ain't by 'isself in dat.

THE MULE

Ef you quiz Br'er Mule, you'll find dat he
Gits mixed on de subjec' of 'is fam'ly tree;
He'll brag about 'is mammy with a noble neigh,
An' deny 'is own daddy wid a ginuine bray.
 But he ain't by 'isself in dat, in dat—
 But he ain't by 'isself in dat.

THE GRUBWORM



Br'er Grubworm wrops 'isself in
twine

An' swings in 'is shroud on a
evergreen vine,

Becaze it's mortal death dat brings
His on'iest chance to git 'is wings.

But you ain't by yo'self, Br'er
Worm, in dat—

Oh, you ain't by yo'self in dat.

RAIN OR SHINE?



Ol' Mingo, on 'is knees, he say:
"Lord, teach dis nigger how to
pray,

Else riconcile two kinds o' weather
For craps an' rheumatiz together!"
But you ain't by yo'self, ol'
man, in dat—

Oh, you ain't by yo'self in dat.

LITTLE GREEN TREE-TOAD

Little green tree-toad on banana leaf,
Plenty po' relations all aroun' 'im in de bog;
But he'd ruther be blind an' dumb an' deaf
Dan to hold a conversation wid a "low-life" frog!
But he ain't no lonesome toady in dat—
No, he ain't by 'isself in dat.

SPARROWS

Dey say dem Sparrers come crost de seas
To eat our surplus grubs an' fleas;
But dey's whupped our birds off'n dis
plantation,
Tell we craves to constrict dey immigration.
An' dey ain't by deyselves in dat, in dat
—
An' dey ain't by deyselves in dat.

THE FLY



Wid dem suction fots, seem lak
Br'er Fly
Mought draw down health ef he
trode de sky;
But he's so onpartic'lar whar he
roams
Dat he's got 'isself screened out o'
quality homes.
An' he ain't by 'isself outcas'
like dat—
No, he ain't by 'isself in dat.

THE LITTLE CHICKEN

Little yaller fluff-ball, one day out,
Steps mighty high while he picks
all about;
Never sees de egg-shell layin' in 'is
track,
Much less the little piece stickin'
on 'is back.

But he ain't by 'isself in dat, in
dat—

But he ain't by 'isself in dat.



THE SCARE-CROW

Br'er Scare-crow's built to suit 'is
job

Wid flappin' legs an' arms dat bob;
He ain't got brains for discontent
So he works widout no argument.

An' he ain't by 'isself in dat, in
dat—

No, he ain't by 'isself in dat.



THE YELLOW ROSE



Dey's a sweet plantation, yaller-
buff rose

Dat in my ricollection grows;
In my ol' dreams she seems to wait
Whar she stood an' bloomed by de
love-vine gate

An' I ain't by myself in
dreams like dat—

No, I ain't by myself in dat.



THE AMBITIOUS COW



Sis' Twis'-horn Brindle is a
bothersome cow,

She's boun' to raise a ruction an'
she don't keer how;

She craves to be de bell-cow an'
lead off wid a clang,

So it's all a man kin do to make 'er
gallup wid de gang.

An' she ain't by 'erself in dat,
in dat—

An' she ain't by 'erself in dat.

TRIED BY FIRE



De sugar-cane stands so proud an'
smart,
You'd nuver suspicion it sweet at
de heart,
But to prove its sweets it yields its

will

To be tried by fire an' ground in de

mill.

An' it ain't by itself in dat, in

dat—

No, it ain't by itself in dat.

JACK-O' LANTERN



Sence he los' 'is brains to git 'is
smile,
Brer Jack-o-lantern grins lak a
wilderin' chile
Widout no secrets out or in;
An' de lighter in de head de
broader 'is grin
An' he ain't by 'isself in dat, in
dat—
An' he ain't by 'isself in dat.

THE FLEA

Look out for Mr. Po'-trash Flea!
Ef you let 'im come in, he'll make too free;
He'll chase yo' dog till he makes 'im pant,
An' he'll take yo' skin for a restaurant.
 An' he ain't by isselt in dat, in dat—
 An' he ain't by 'isselt in dat.

WILL O' THE WISP

Ef de Wul o' de Wust would cuss
an' swear

An' take some shape, an' rip an'
tear,

It wouldn't sen' col' chills down a
nigger's spine

Like de changeable expression of a
mystery shine.

An' it ain't by its ghostly self
in dat—

No, it ain't by itself in dat.



THE MOLE

De blind mole tunnels straight ahead,
An' he gits whar he gwine wid a trustful tread,
But he nuver is yit got nowhar else,
An' he'll nuver view de skies whar glory melts.
 But he ain't by 'isself in dat, in dat—
 But he ain't by 'isself in dat.

THE RUNT



You'll sometimes trace de loudes'
grunt
In de horg-lot down to de littles'
runt,
Lak as ef he'd 'nounce whilst he
gulps 'is swill,
"A pompious horg is as big as 'is
will."
An' he ain't by 'isself in dat, in
dat—
No, he ain't by 'isself in dat.

THE MONKEY



De organ plays an' Br'er Monkey
struts,
An' he takes high pride in de
capers he cuts,
While folks draps picayunes into
'is han'
For fallin' so short o' bein' a man.
An' he ain't by 'isself, misled
like dat—
No, he ain't by 'isself in dat.

THE ARISTOCRAT



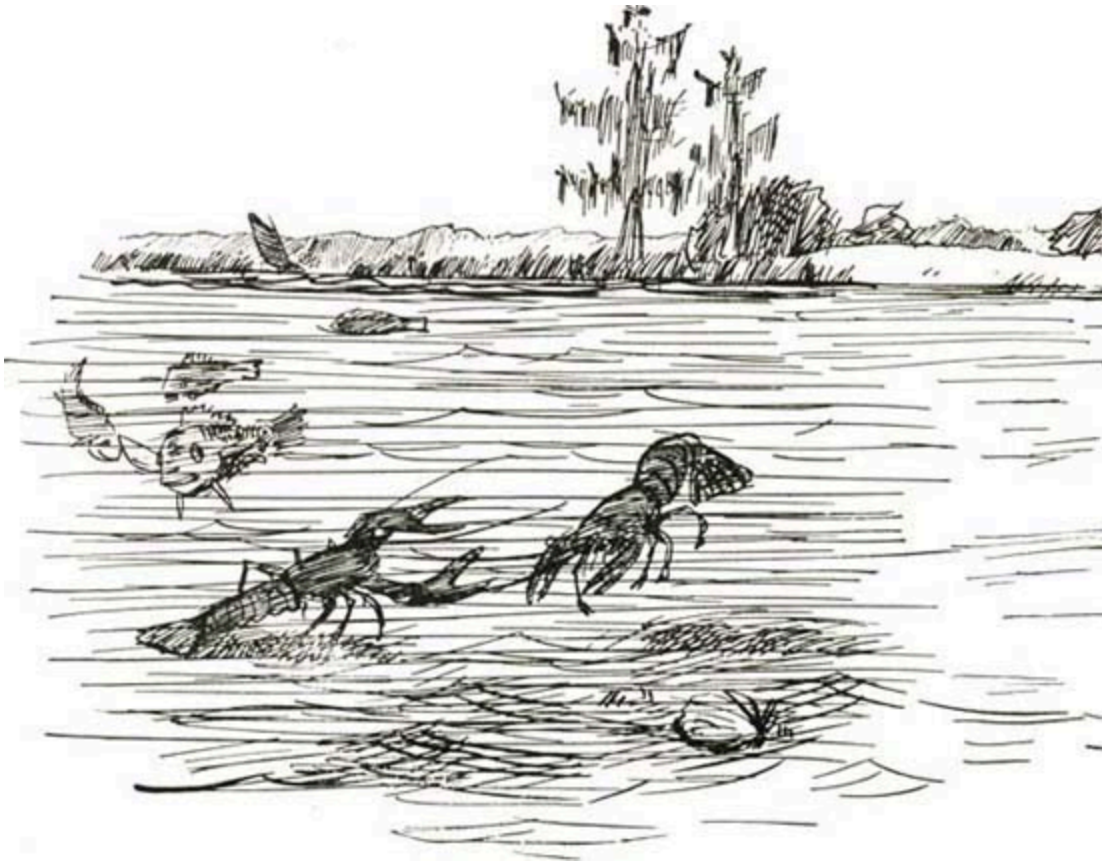
Dat three-name chicken wid de
feathery legs
Wha' 'merged f'om de ten dollar
settin' of eggs,
Is a lonesome bird an' I s'picion he
frets
'Ca'ze he can't outgrow dem
pantalettes.

An' he ain't by 'isself in dat, in
dat—

An' he ain't by 'isself in dat.

THE CRAWFISH

Br'er Crawfish th'ows a racklass
bluff,
An' he sho do look like fightin'
stuff;
But turn 'im loose on a battle-
groun',
An' he'll bow 'isself out, an' nuver
turn roun'.
But he ain't by 'isself in dat, in
dat—
But he ain't by 'isself in dat.



THE ANGLEWORM

"I could stand de hook," says de
angleworm,
"An' a lily-brook wouldn't make
me squirm,
But I can't help wrigglin' ag'in' my
fate;
It breaks me all up to be used for
bait."
An' he ain't by 'isself in dat, in
dat—
An' he ain't by 'isself in dat.



THE CHIMNEY-SWALLOW



Wid 'is nest in de flue whar de
suctions blow,

Storms due above an' fire below,
No wonder Br'er Swaller sags an'
sways

Like a pusson ableeged to dodge
bofe ways.

An' he ain't by 'isself in dat, in
dat—

An' he ain't by 'isself in dat.

CATCHING DOODLE-BUGS



Little picaninnies, fishin' in de
doodle-bug holes.

Wid a "spit for luck," an' straws for
poles,

Show pyore delight in de
fisherman's aim

All disp'opo'tioned to de game.

An' dey ain't by deyselves in
dat, in dat—

An' dey ain't by deyselves in
dat.

THE PORCUPINE

Sis' Porcupine, wid 'er bristles all
set

In a pompado' style, is waitin' yet,
An' she can't understan', whilst she
puckers 'er mug,
De sca'city o' kisses an' de absent
hug.

But she ain't by 'er lonesome
self in dat—

No, she ain't by 'erself in dat.



ANTS

Dem Ants is sho' got savin' ways
An' even de Scripture 'lows 'em praise;
But dey hoa'ds for deyselves f'om day to day
An' dey stings any man wha' gits in de way.
 An' dey ain't no new co'poration in dat—
 No, dey ain't by deyselves in dat.

THE PARROT

Sis' Tin-cage Polly wid de roamin'
nose
Dat roams f'om 'er eyes tel it p'int to
'er toes,
She keeps up a ratlin' talkin' pace
To turn off attention f'om de shape of
'er face.
An' you ain't by yo'self, Sis'
Polly, in dat—
No, you ain't by yo'self in dat.

THE RATTLE-SNAKE



Br'er Rattle-snake rattles befo' he
springs,
But he warns too late to 'scape 'is
stings;
His high-class manners don't count
for much
'Ca'ze dey grafted on to a sarpent's
touch.
An' he ain't by 'isself in dat, in
dat—
An' he ain't by 'isself in dat.

THE PERSIMMON



Is you little gals, growin' into
women,
Ever tasted a snappy young
persimmin?
It takes a hard frost to make it
sweet,
An' it's ol' an' swiveled 'fo' it's fit to
eat!
But it ain't by itself, sharp
chillen, in dat—
No, it ain't by itself in dat.

IN HARNESS

Dat flee-bitten mule an' my bay
mare

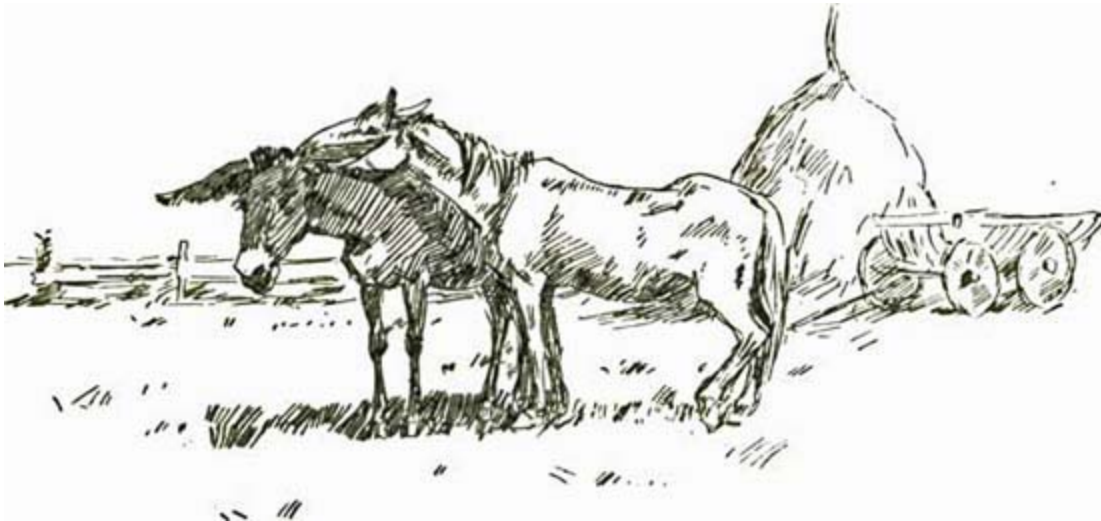
In de hay-wagon, sho is a mixtious
pair;

But dey's pulled so long th'ough
wind an' weather

Dat out in de field dey graze
together.

An' dey ain't by deyselves in
dat, in dat—

An' dey ain't by deyselves in
dat.



THE CANARY



De little yaller cage-bird preems 'is
wings
An' he mounts 'is pyerch an' sings
an' sings;
He feels 'is cage, but I s'pec' he
'low
To take what comes an' sing
anyhow!
An' you ain't by yo'self, little
bird, in dat—
No, you ain't by yo'self in dat.

ANSWERING BACK

Br'er Pole-cat's got a s'ciety smile
An' he sho is dressed in
scrumptious style,
But he keeps 'is own hat off de
quality rack
By de scan'lous way he answers
back.

But he ain't by 'isself in dat, in
dat—

But he ain't by 'isself in dat.



DAT'S DE WAY MY LADY'LL DO

It ain't how many eyes you got,
 'Les' needles could see an' potatoes, too;
An' "hookin' a' eye," as like as not,
 Would be classed as a sin dat no lady'd
do.

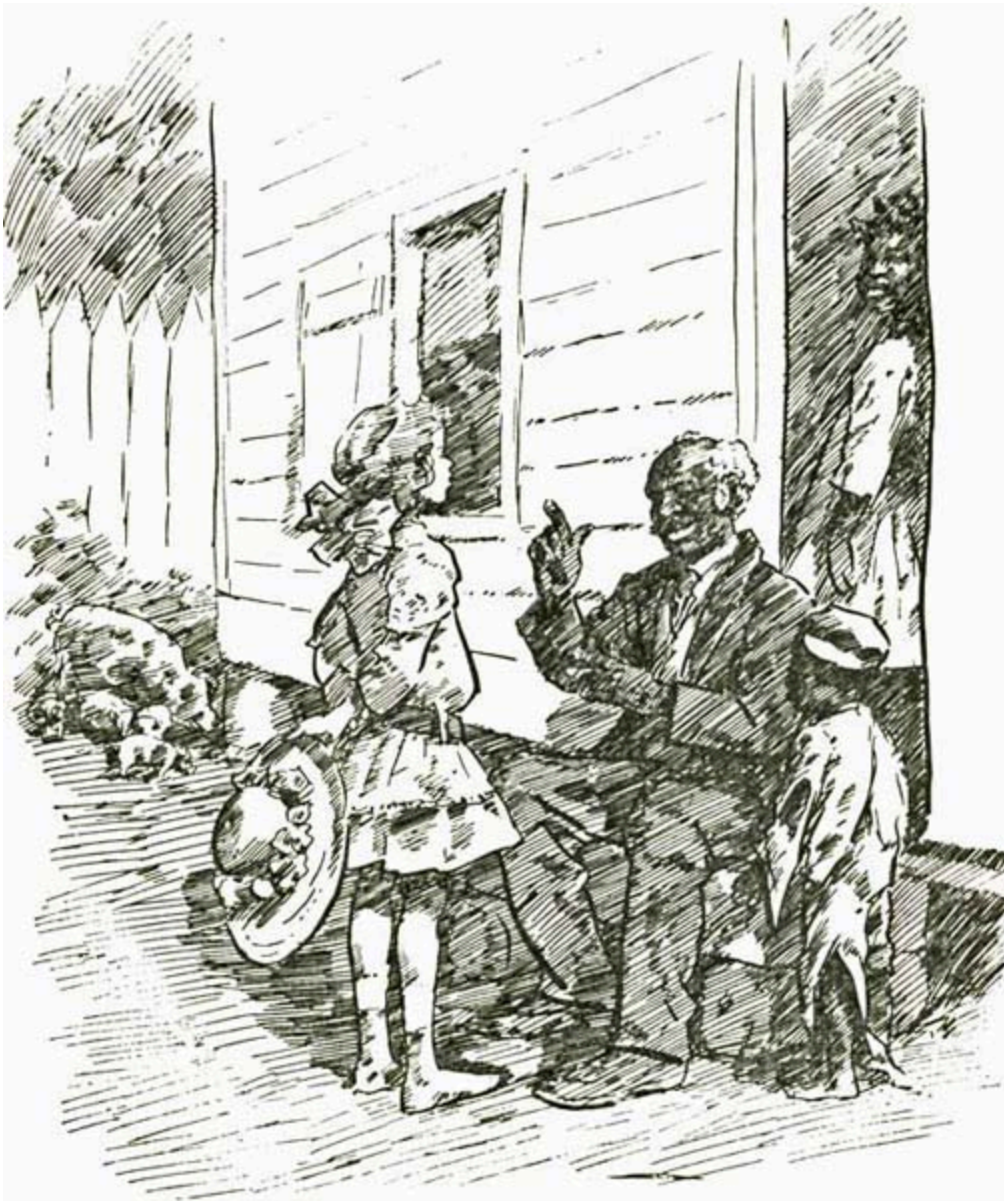
 But it's keepin' yo' eyes turned
to'des de right,
 An' to'des de wrong jes' shettin'
'em tight—

 Lookin' out for ways to be polite—
Dat's de way my lady'd do!

It ain't how many ears you got
 Dat makes you listen an' learn an' do;
Else a hill o' corn in a garden plot
 Would be 'way ahead o' me an' you;
 But it's shettin' yo' ears to heartless
speech,
 An' listenin' whilst de teachers
teach,
 An' strivin' to practise mo' 'n to
preach—
 Dat's de way my lady'll do!

It ain't how many tongues you got,
 'Les' shoes would talk an' wagons, too;
An' all de bells would gabble a lot,
 An' tattle an' brag de long day th'ough;
 But it's gyardin' yo' tongue f'om
talk dat's wrong,
 An' passin' a helpful word along,
 An' maybe singin' a hopeful song

Dat's de way my lady'll do!



THE MAMMY ALLIGATOR



Said de mammy alligator, wid a
motherly grin:

"I nuver liked babies wid dey
dimples tucked in,

But our little pet, wid its horny
hide,

Like its mammy's an' its daddy's, is
de fam'ly pride."

An' dey ain't by deyselves in
dat, in dat—

An' dey ain't by deyselves in
dat.

THE NEW RICH



Sis' Mush A. Roon sprung up over
night
An' to name whar she sprung f'om
ain't polite;
But she spreads 'erself wuss'n me
or you,
An' wid on'y one foot to stan' on,
too.
An she ain't by er new-come
self in dat—

No, she ain't by 'erself in dat.



THE WIBBLY WABBLY CALF

Cunnin' little donkey-baby—
"Ye-haw! Ye-haw!" What a
funny laugh!

Soun' jes like a creaky, cranky
Seesaw—seesaw!
Wasn't nothin' funny roun' dat
We saw—we saw!
'Tel we glimpsed de stagger-gait
dat

He saw—he saw!
Brindle strikin' swagger-gait when
She saw—she saw—*her*
wibbly wabbly calf!



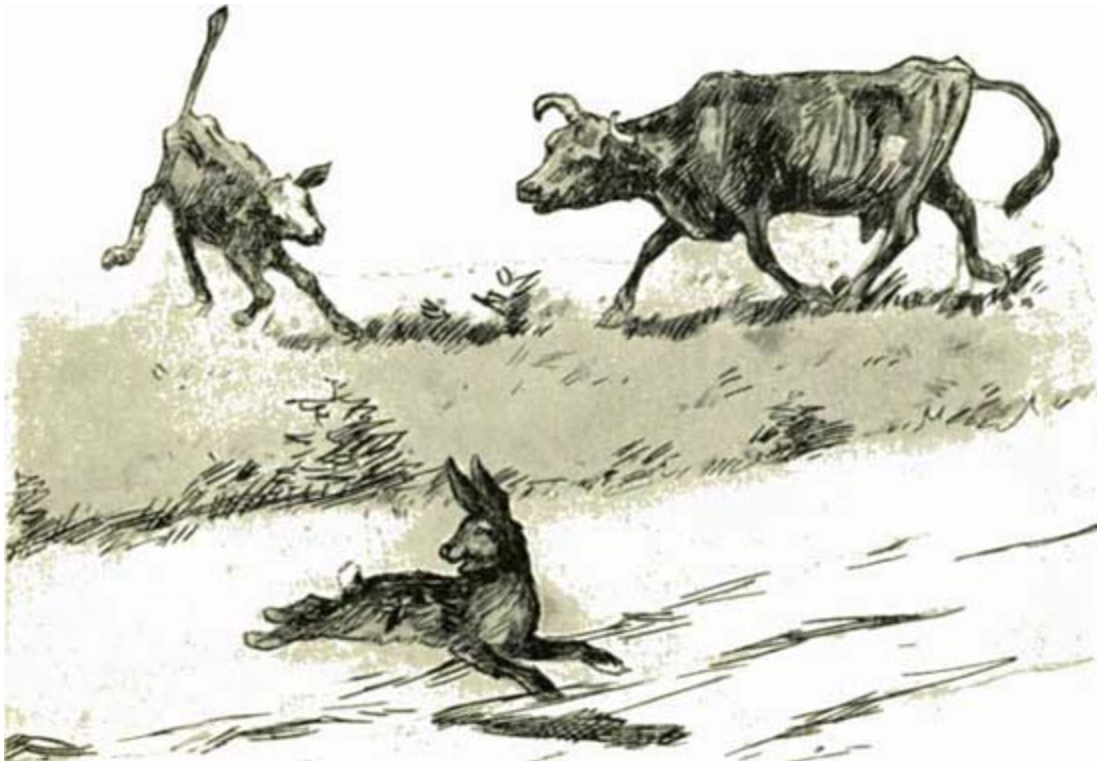
Den we j'ined wid Mister Donkey,
"He-haw! He-haw!" How
we-all did laugh!

But we laughed at some'h'n' mo'
dan

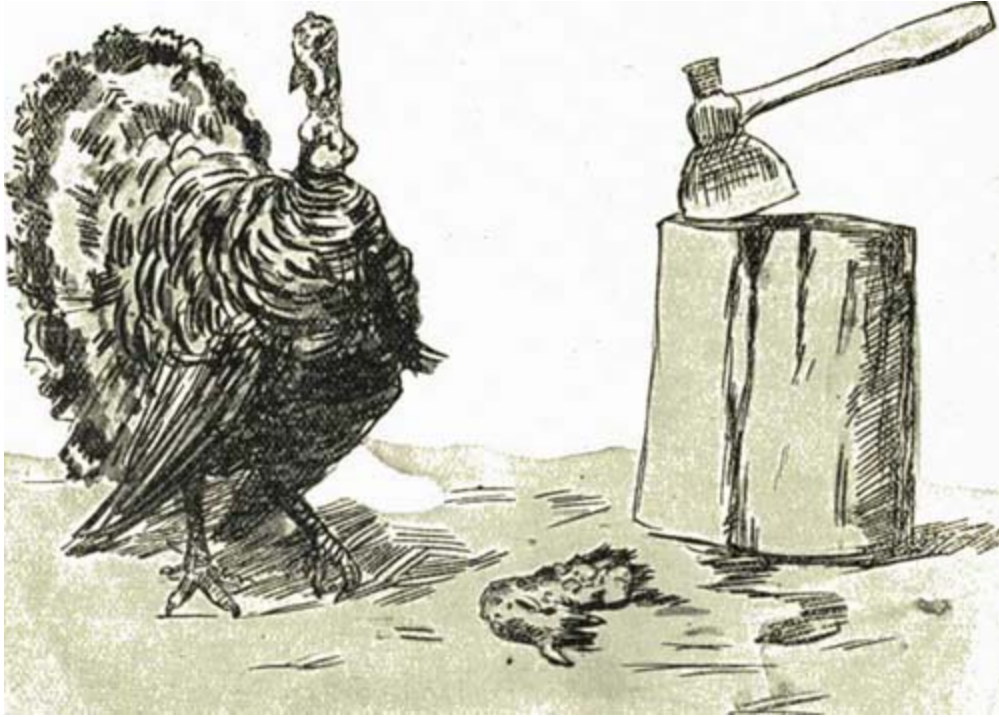
He saw—he saw!
Donkey couldn't see de ears dat
We saw—we saw!
Rabbit lopin' down de road, we
Three saw—three saw!
Wagged his ears an' called him
daddy!

"Haw-haw! Haw-haw!"
How dat—who dat laugh?

An' de last to see de joke was
wibbly wabbly calf!



THE TURKEY-GOBBLER



Ol' Gobbly struts aroun' de stable
An' th'ows out hints o' de rich
man's table,
An' he h'ists his tail an' spreads it
wide,
To display his cuyus graveyard
pride.
But he ain't by 'isself in pride
like dat—
But he ain't by 'isself in dat.

THE CAULIFLOWER

When de cabbage got ambitiom, in
a uppish hour

An' lost 'is head an' bu'st into
flower

Wid 'is brains outside, an addled,
at dat—

He sot 'isself up for a 'ristocrat.
An' he ain't by 'isself in dat, in
dat—

An' he ain't by 'isself in dat.



THE STEPMOTHER



Sis' Dominick follers her brood o'
ducks
To de bayou's edge, an' she clucks
an' clucks:
'Dis stepmammy job, oh me, oh
me!
Ain't all dat it's quacked up to be!"
But she ain't by 'erself in dat,
in dat—
But she ain't by 'erself in dat.

THE FROG



Ol' Br'er Frog ain't much to sing,
But he clairs a log in a single
spring,
An' jedgin' 'im by his bigotry ways,
He's clean forgot 'is tadpole days!
But he ain't by 'isself in dat, in
dat—
But he ain't by 'isself in dat.

THE RAT



Br'er Rat in de corn-bin over-fed
An' under-worked, an' now he's
dead;
He craved to live lak a bloated
chief,
An' now he ain't nothin' but a ol'
dead thief.
An' he ain't by 'isself in dat, in
dat—
No, he ain't by 'isself in dat.

THE MOCKING-BIRD

Br'er mockin'-bird sings in de live-oak shade,
A secon'-hand chant or a serenade;
He'll take off a pa'tridge, a robin, or a jay,
But he'd nuver make a name no other way.
 But he ain't by 'isself in dat, in dat—
 But he ain't by 'isself in dat.

THE MUSHROOM



Dey's many a musharoon good to
de tas'e
An' rich for de table, dat goes to
was'e
'Ca'ze folks don't dast to gether it
in
For de way it favors its dung-hill
kin.

An' it ain't by itself
condemned like dat—

No, it ain't by itself in dat

THE MEASURING WORM



When Br'er Measurin'-worm
strikes out so brave,
Makin' tend he kin measure you
for yo grave,

Wid all 'is stride an' all 'is stren'th
He can't measure mo'n 'is own
little len'th.

An' he ain't by 'isself made
cheap like dat—

No, he ain't by 'isself like dat.

THE TOP-KNOT HEN



Hit's a proper pride in Sis' Top-
knot's breast

Dat makes 'er step to march 'er
crest;

Yit jealousy follers 'er 'roun' de shed
On de count o' dat innercent tufted
head.

An' she ain't by 'erself
pursued lak dat—

No, she ain't by 'erself in dat.

TOO FAMILIAR



De cantelope gits mighty bilious
F'om runnin' wid punkins too
familias,
So it's banished out for its sociable
sin
Along wid its yaller kitchen kin.
An' it ain't by itself in dat, in
dat—
An' it ain't by itself in dat.

THE 'POSSUM

Br'er 'Possum makes pertend he's
dead

Whilst shots goes whizzin' over 'is
head.

But time de hounds is out o' sight,
He's up an' "hongry for a fight!"
An' he ain't by 'isself in a
bluff like dat—

No, he ain't by 'isself in dat.



THE OWL

When de big owl calls out "*Who—ooo—ooo*
—!!!!!"

In de dark o' de moon, like night-owls do,
De chillen, a-beggin' to play out late,
Come tumblin' back into Daddy's gate.

An' dey ain't by deyselves in dat, in dat—
No, dey ain't by deyselves in dat.

THE CHAMELEON

De camelia-lizard is a turn-coat
man,

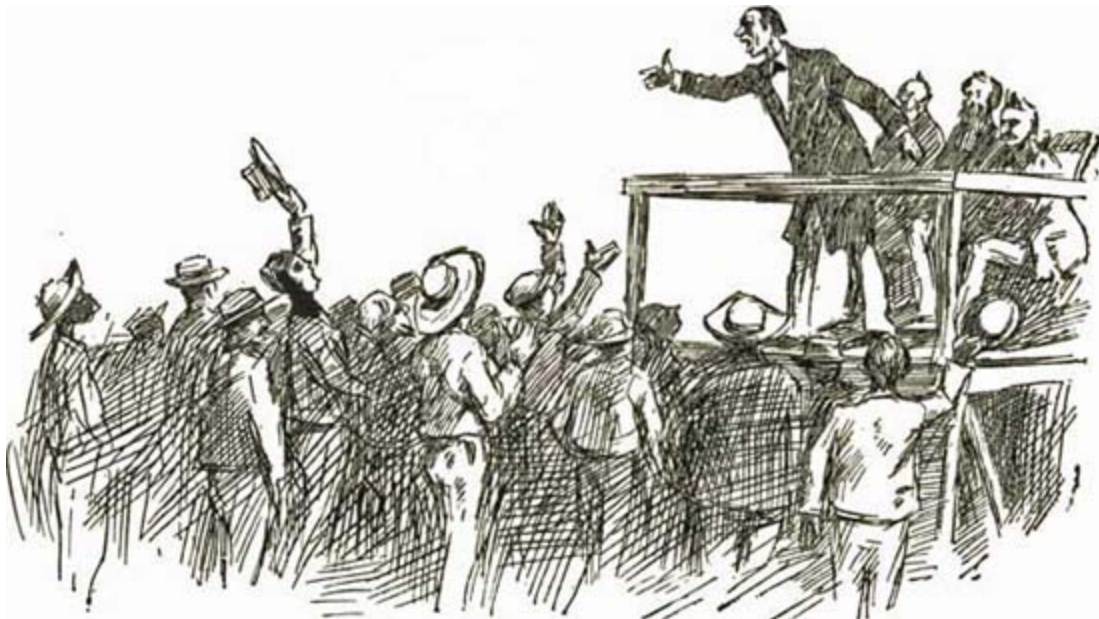
An' he borries his colors where
dey's "room to stan";

He mought keep solid as a county
candidate,

But you couldn't sca'cely find 'im
on a map o' de State.

But he ain't by 'isself lost out,
like dat—

No, he ain't by 'isself in dat.



THE CATERPILLAR

Whilst she eats de groun' f'om
onder 'er feet,

Sis' Caterpillar's weavin' 'er
windin'-sheet;

But 'er red eyes shine an' 'er grass-
green-hair,

An' 'er short life's bright, so she
don't care.

An' she ain't by 'erself in dat,
in dat—

An' she ain't by 'erself in dat.



DR. DRAKE

Ol' Dr. Drake wid 'is college
waddle

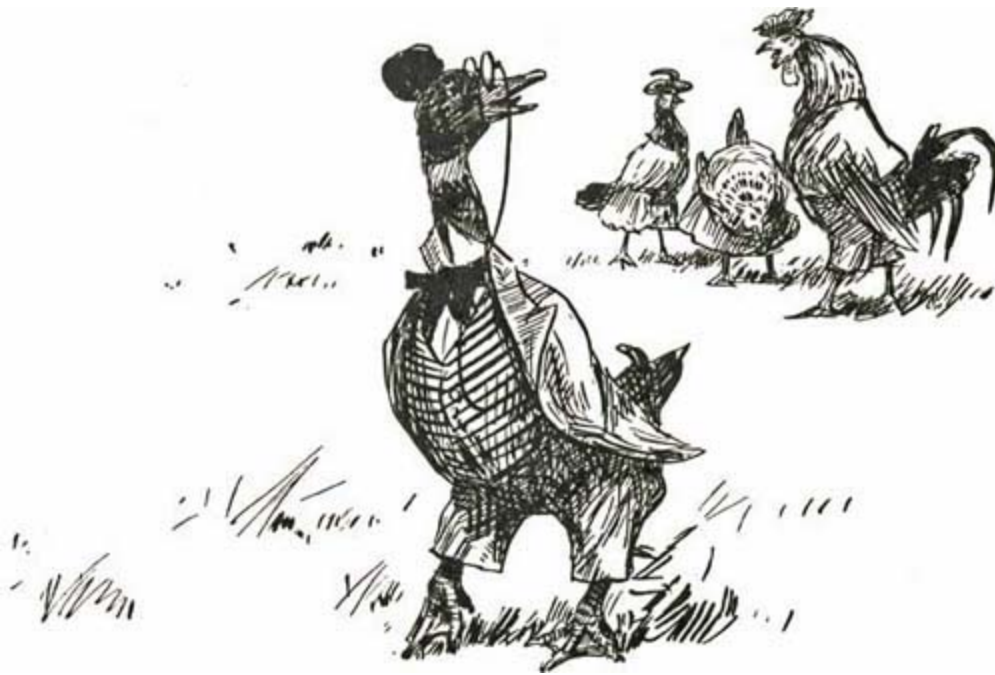
An' Latin inscriptions on 'is
noddle,

Would part wid 'is gait an' 'is
shimmerin' back

To perscribe a *crowin'-powder* an'
nuver say "Quack!"

But he ain't by 'isself in dat, in
dat—

But he ain't by 'isself in dat.



THE PEACOCK

Br'er Peacock 'lows he's a
'ristocrat,
Wid mighty fine clo'es, an' vain at
dat;
He'll answer yo' glance wid col'
surprise
An' look you over wid a thousan'
eyes!
But he ain't by 'isself in dat, in
dat—
But he ain't by 'isself in dat.



THE ALLIGATOR



Br'er Alligator kin grin a mile,
But dey ain't no inducemint in his
smile;
Whilst he ain't no race-horse, yit
dey say
A little alligator goes a mighty
long way.
But he ain't by 'isself in dat, in
dat—
But he ain't by 'isself in dat.

THE TERRAPIN



Br'er Tarrapin draws in 'is head so
knowin',
You can't tell whether he's comin'
or goin',
But *his* mind ain't mixed—he's
layin' low
Tel he sees which way he's
obleegeed to go.
An' he ain't no new politician
in dat—
No, he ain't by 'isself in dat.

THE DANDELION



De dandelion flower blooms out so
young
Wid a look in its face like a sassy
tongue,
Den it grows light-headed wid
self-conceit
Wid a flighty ol' age, for full
defeat.
An' it ain't by itself, pert
chillen, in dat—
No, it ain't by itself in dat.

THE CUD



"Life's give an' take," Sis' Cow, she
laugh.
So I gives my milk an' dey takes
my calf."
An' when contentment's hard to
fin',
She chaws 'er cud to ease 'er min'.
And you ain't by yo'self, Sis'
Cow, in dat—
No, you ain't by yo'self in dat.

THE MIRROR

Br'er Donkey, drinkin' at de brook,
Surveys hisself wid offish look,
An' 'low: "You Jackass makes too
free!
Huccome you dast to drink wid
me!"
An' he ain't by 'isself in dat, in
dat—
Oh, he ain't by 'isself in dat.



GOSLINGS

De purty yaller goslin's say:

"Oh, what—oh, what's de use!

When Mama say, 'Come, walk dis way

An' ac' jes like a goose!

Oh, what's de use—oh, what's

de use?

I's boun' to grow a

noddle,

Like every goosey, goosey,

goose,

An' waddle, waddle,

waddle!

"But Mama say: 'Don't talk dat way!

Come, waddle like a mild goose,

F'om side to side, wid proper pride—

Not like a woodsy wild goose!

Dey's plenty use—dey's

plenty use!

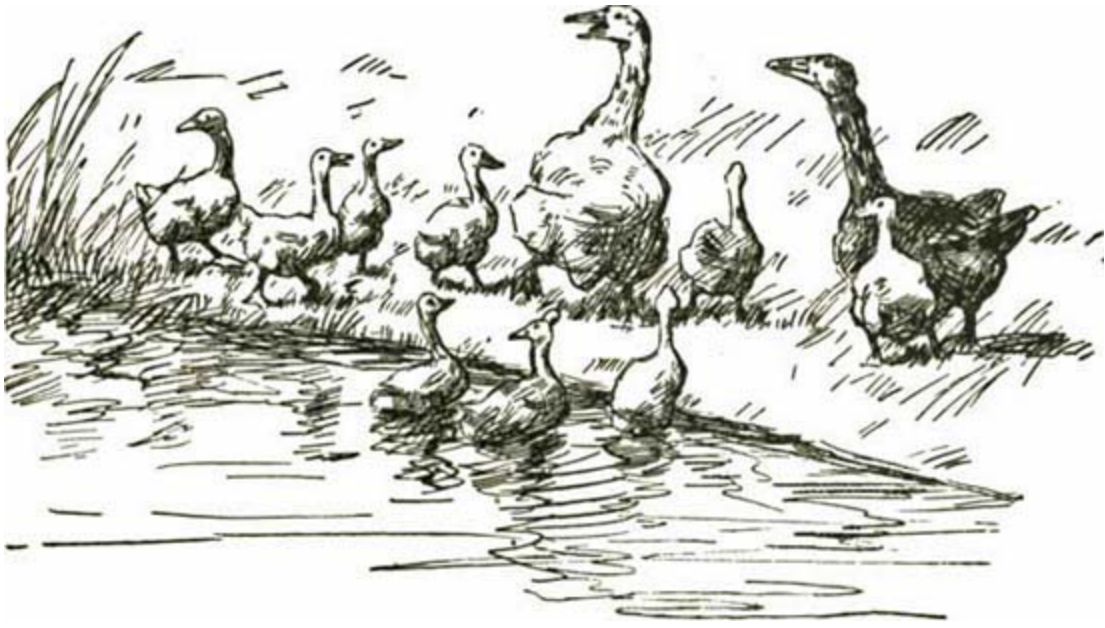
Come, git yo' education!

See how to waddle an' tote yo'

noddle

Accordin' to yo'

station!""



THE PET

De little white chicken dat's petted
too much

Gits stunted in growth f'om de
sp'ilin' touch.

An' she'll niver make a hen so
brave an' good

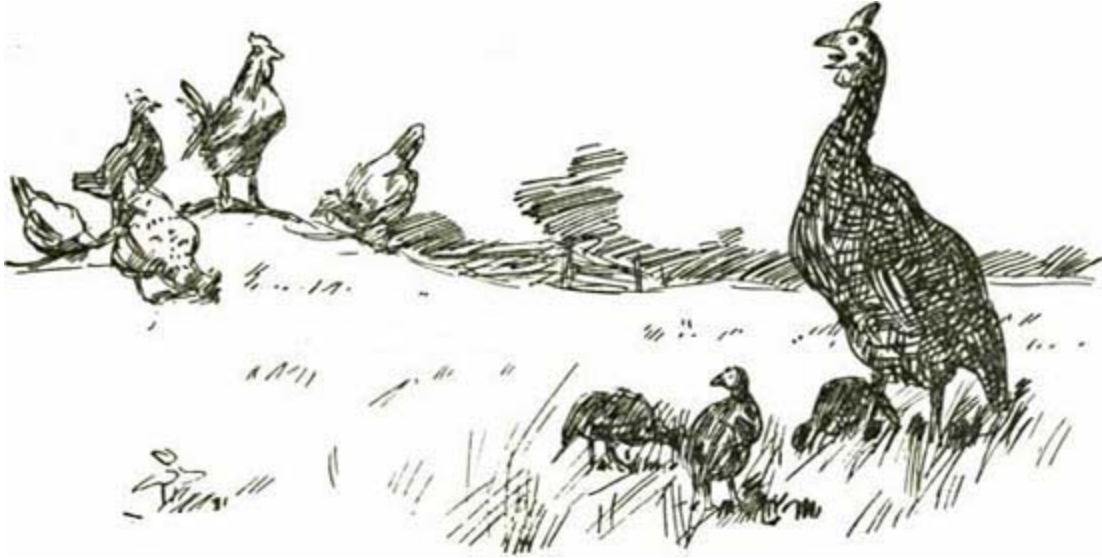
As ef she went a-pickin', an'
worked wid de brood.

An' she ain't by 'erself in dat,
in dat—

No, she ain't by 'erself in dat.

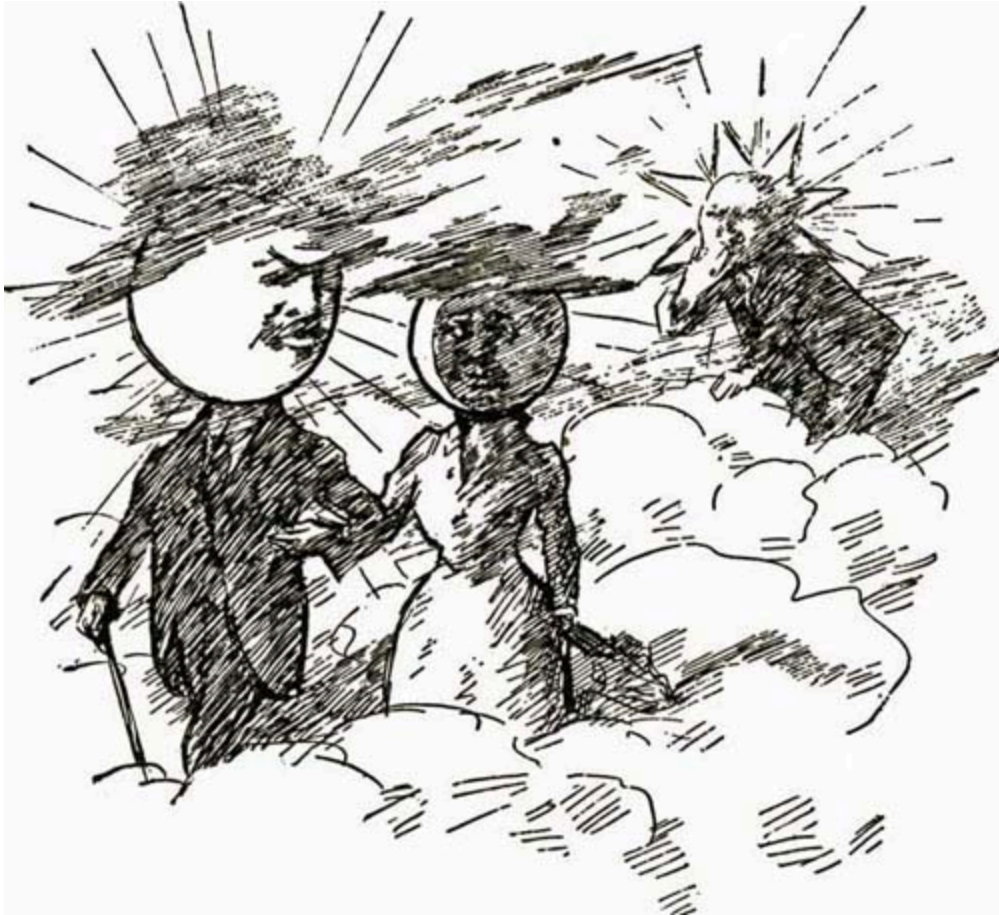


THE GUINEA-HEN



Sis' Guinea, in proud week-day
clo'es
Forgits how she was hatched
outdo's;
Wid 'er red boot chicks, she cuts a
dash,
An' calls 'er neighbors "*Po' trash!*"^[1]
Po' trash!"
— But she ain't by 'erself in dat
But she ain't by 'erself in dat.

THE MOON



Dey say Sis' Moon daresn't shine
at night
Cep'n by Marse Sun's allowance o'
light,
An' whilst he's away whar de
yether moons are
She don't even dast to wink at a
star.
An' she ain't de onies' wife
like dat—
No, she ain't by 'erself in dat.

THE HEN-ROOST MAN

De Hen-roost Man he'll preach about Paul,
An' James an' John, an' Herod, an' all,
But nuver a word about Peter, oh, no!
He's afeard he'll hear dat rooster crow.
 An' he ain't by 'isself in dat, in dat—
 An' he ain't by 'isself in dat.

A GUILTY CONSCIENCE

Dat little yaller pup 's got so many
lickin's
For pesterin' all de ducks an'
chickens,
Dat whenever he hears any barn-
yard strife,
He looks over his shoulder an' runs
for 's life.
But he ain't by 'isself in dat, in
dat—
No, he ain't by 'isself in dat.



THE BAT



Br'er Bat flaps out in de gloomin'
dark,
An' even ef he's boun' for a
harmless lark,
He favors de devil an' he keeps
sech hours
Dat he seems in cahoot wid de evil
powers.
An' he ain't by 'isself in dat, in
dat—
An' he ain't by 'isself in dat.

INCUBATOR CHICKENS



Dem inkybator chickens dat's
hatched by de clock,

Wid a lamp for love, is lonesome
stock;

Dey feeds in droves, but dey
envies de others

Dat scratches for grubs wid any ol'
mothers.

An' dey ain't by deyselves, po'
orphans, in dat—

No, dey ain't by deyselves in
dat.

THE FIREFLY



Br'er Lightnin'-bug is a gay yo'ng
spark,
But he nuver is yit put out de dark;
He shines for 'isself in 'is zigzag
flight,
An' he's middlin' sho he's de sou'ce
of light.
But he ain't by 'isself in dat, in
dat—

But he ain't by 'isself in dat.



THE THISTLE

De thistle-stalk sends up a noble
bloom

Wid de shape of a flower an' de
thought of a plume,

But its prickle-y ways turn
friendship down;

So it stands all alone, in its velvet
gown.

An' it ain't by its lonesome
self in dat—

No, it ain't by itself in dat.



THE GRAY SQUIRREL



De gray squir'l lives a nachel life,
Wid friends an' foes an' chillen an'
wife;
But whenever he gits his picture
took,
He snatches dat nut, to appear in
de book.
But he ain't by 'isself in dat, in
dat—
But he ain't by 'isself in dat.

LOOK OUT FOR MISTER BEE



Look out for Mister Bee in de
punkin-flower!

Plenty gallinippers in de grass!
Mighty close tie 'twix' wings an'
stings

Better let de honey-bee pass!

Z—Z—Z, Z, Z!

Better let de honey-bee pass!

White-face bumblebee—white
folks' ways—

Never give a sassy answer back!
But don't you trus' de black-face,
no matter what he says!

Give de nigger bumblebee de
track!

Z—Z—Z, Z, Z!

track!^[2] Give de nigger bumblebee de

THE ROSE

When Sis' Rose th'ows open her heart *too proud*,
She blooms mighty brief in Beauty's crowd;
'Ca'ze the rains beat in an' de bees make free
'Tel de heart o' de rose is sad to see.
 An' you ain't by yo'self, Sis' Rose, in dat—
 No, you ain't by yo'self in dat.

THE LOCOMOTIVE



Dey say Sis' Engine's fiercest
scream
Don't mean nothin' but lettin' off
steam,
But wid so much wrackage behin'
'er back,
Seem like she say: "Git out o' my
track!"

An' she ain't by 'erself, old
Mis, in dat—
No, she ain't by 'erself in dat.

THE GOAT

No matter how much she strive to
'spire,

Sis' Nannie Goat's measured 'g'inst
some'h'n' higher;

"First cousin to a sheep" an' "de
po' man's cow,"

Is hol'-down luck, come when,
come how.

An' she ain't by 'erself helt
down like dat—

No, she ain't by 'erself in dat.



THE FIG

De fig dat's "sweet enough to eat"
Is *sweet enough*, but *not too sweet*;
But de honey-lip fig in de blazin' light
Is a battle-ground whar de varmints fight.
 An' it ain't by itself in dat, in dat—
 An' it ain't by itself in dat.

THE FRIZZLED CHICKEN



Dat frizzledy chicken, he steps so
spry,
An' he totes 'is head so pompious
high,
Like as ef he tries, wharever he
goes,
To rise above dem rough-dried
clo'es.
dat—
An' he ain't by 'isself in dat, in
An' he ain't by 'isself in dat.

THE ENDLESS SONG

Oh, I used to sing a song,
An' dey said it was too long,
So I cut it off de en'
To accommodate a frien'
Nex' do', nex' do'—
To accommodate a frien' nex' do'.

But it made de matter wuss
Dan it had been at de fus,
'Ca'ze de en' was gone, an' den
Co'se it didn't have no en'
Any mo', any mo'—
Oh, it didn't have no en' any mo'!

So, to save my frien' from sinnin',
I cut off de song's beginnin';
Still he cusses right along
Whilst I sings *about* my song
Jes so, jes so—
Whilst I sings *about* my song *jes*

so.

How to please 'im is my riddle,
So I'll fall back on my fiddle;
For I'd stan' myself on en'
To accommodate a frien'
Nex' do', nex' do'—
To accommodate a frien' nex' do'.



THE EEL

Br'er Eel got a mighty jewbious name,
But maybe he ain't so much to blame;
He couldn't squirm out ef he niver ventured in,
An' he resks his all when he resks his skin.

But he ain't by 'isself in dat, in dat—
But he ain't by 'isself in dat.



THE RAIN-CROW



Br'er Rain-crow sho kin prophesy,
Caze he reads his wisdom f'om de
page on high;
His mind ain't clogged wid secon'-
hand facts,
But de moon an' de skies is his
almanacs.

An' he ain't by 'isself in dat, in
dat—

An' he ain't by 'isself in dat.

THE GIRAFFE

pertense
neighbor's fence,
'spec'
"Rubber-neck!!!"
dat, in dat—
dat.

Br'er Gy-raffe don't make no
O' not seein' over 'is
An' ef he'd listen close-t, I
He'd hear somebody say:
But he ain't by 'isself in
But he ain't by 'isself in

THE BLACK SHEEP



De black sheep says, "Oh, what's
de use
To shun de mire an' de muddy
sluice?
For whether I walks for praise or
blame,
Dey'll call me 'black sheep,' jes de
same!"
An' he ain't by 'isself in dat, in
dat—
An' he ain't by 'isself in dat.

THE PRIZE-WINNER

Dat Berkshire horg in de blue
ribbon pen
Come home wid de heavy-weight
prize again;
He looks mighty pompous in 'is
stall,
But he's on'y a fat horg, after all.
An' he ain't by 'isself in dat, in
dat—
An' he ain't by 'isself in dat.



THE DOG



	I can't talk dog an' he can't talk
man,	
	Yit Rover an' me, we onderstan';
	I wag my tongue an' he wags 'is
tail,	
	An' Love explains whar grammars
fail.	
	An' we ain't by ourselves in
dat, in dat—	
	No, we ain't by ourselves in
dat.	

FOOTNOTES:

[1] The guinea-fowl strays away from home and makes her nest in the fields. The newly hatched guinea-chicks are beautiful, dainty things, with coral-colored feet which look very fine. The guinea's cry, loud and harsh, sounds like "Potterack!" or "Poor trash!"

[2] The white-faced bee does not sting.

*** END OF THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK DADDY DO-
FUNNY'S WISDOM JINGLES ***

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